



(12) **United States Plant Patent**
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(10) **Patent No.:** **US PP28,692 P3**
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(54) **STRAWBERRY PLANT NAMED ‘PLAYA’**
(50) Latin Name: *Fragaria*×*ananassa*
Varietal Denomination: **Playa**
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A01H 5/08 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./209**
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USPC Plt./208, 209
See application file for complete search history.
(56) **References Cited**

PUBLICATIONS

Trademark citation on “NAIA”, published Feb. 28, 2012.*
* cited by examiner

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(57) **ABSTRACT**
The present invention provides a new and distinct strawberry plant designated as ‘Playa’ (a.k.a. ‘108926’).
5 Drawing Sheets

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Latin name of the genus and species: *Fragaria*×*ananassa*.
Varietal denominations: ‘Playa’ (a.k.a. ‘108926’).

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct strawberry variety designated as ‘Playa’ (a.k.a. ‘108926’).
‘Playa’ (a.k.a. ‘108926’) is the result of a controlled-cross between a female parent cultivar designated 107707 and a male parent cultivar designated 103474 (both unpatented, proprietary cultivars) made by the Inventor and was first fruited in Watsonville, Calif. growing fields. Following selection and during testing, the plant was originally designated ‘108926’ and subsequently named ‘Playa’.
This new variety was asexually reproduced via runners (stolons) by the inventor at Watsonville, Calif. Asexual propagules from the original source have been tested in Watsonville growing fields and to a limited extent, grower fields in high elevation. The properties of this variety were found to be transmissible by such asexual reproduction. This cultivar is stable and reproduces true to type in successive generations of asexual reproduction.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

This invention relates to new and distinctive strawberry cultivar designated as ‘Playa’. These cultivars are primarily adapted to the climate and growing conditions of the central coast of California. This region provides the necessary temperatures required for it to produce a strong vigorous plant and to remain in fruit production from March through October. The nearby Pacific Ocean provides the needed humidity and moderate day temperatures and evening chilling to maintain fruit quality for the production months.
The following traits and photographs in combination distinguish strawberry variety ‘Playa’ from known straw-

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berry varieties. In addition, this new cultivar was confirmed to be a unique strawberry germplasm when tested against the California Seed & Plant Lab, Inc. (Elverta, Calif.) database using Short Sequence Repeats (SSRs). Plants for the botanical measurements in the present application were grown as annuals. Any color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 1995 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used. The fruit produced by this new cultivar is attractive and of excellent quality.

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The accompanying color photographs depict various characteristics of the cultivars as nearly true as possible to make color reproductions.
FIG. 1 shows ripe fruits of ‘Playa’.
FIG. 2 shows ‘Playa’ plants in the field with ripe and near-ripe fruits.
FIG. 3 shows ‘Playa’ plants growing in the field.
FIG. 4 shows ‘Playa’ plant leaves with petioles.
FIG. 5 shows a close-up look of a ‘Playa’ plant leaf.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

‘Playa’ (a.k.a. ‘108926’)
This invention relates to a new and distinctive strawberry cultivar designated as ‘Playa’. It is primarily adapted to the climate and growing conditions of the central coast of California. This region provides the necessary temperatures required for it to produce a strong vigorous plant and to remain in fruit production from March through October. The nearby Pacific Ocean provides the needed humidity and moderate day temperatures and evening chilling to maintain fruit quality for the production months.

The following traits in combination distinguish strawberry variety ‘Playa’ from the known strawberry varieties. Plants for the botanical measurements in the present application were grown as annuals. In the following description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 1995 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

‘Playa’ has not been observed under all possible environmental conditions, and the phenotype may vary significantly with variations in environment. The following observations, measurements, and comparisons describe this plant as grown under normal conditions in Watsonville, Calif. unless otherwise noted.

Hybrid Patent Data Sheet (planted: October Year 1; measurement: November Year 2) Variety: PLAYA (A.K.A. ‘108926’)	
Plant	
Plant Growth Habit	Semi-upright
Day length	neutral
Planting Season	fall
Height (mm)	380
Diameter (mm)	360 (the entire plant structure, including the “superstructure” of petioles, leaves, flowers) 70 (inner “base” or “heart” structure of the plant, i.e. the mature apical and axial crowns of the strawberry plant where petioles, flowers and runners are attached)
Density of foliage	heavy
Average number of crowns per mature plant	4
Plant vigor	high
Rain/weather tolerance (e.g., high, moderate, or low)	moderate
Harvest Ease	moderate
Terminal Leaf	
Length (mm)	99
Width (mm)	91
Terminal leaflet length/width ratio	0.9
Blistering	none
Terminal leaf shape	orbicular
Number of teeth/terminal leaflet:	20
Shape of the terminal leaflet base	obtuse
Shape of terminal leaflet in cross-section	concave
Margin description of the terminal	serrate
Shape of teeth	obtuse
Color of upper side of leaves	137A
Color of lower side of leaves	139C
Leaf glossiness	medium to weak
presence or absence of any leaf variegation	absence
Number of leaflets	66
Terminal Leaflet margin	flat
Terminal Leaflet shape of apex	rounded
Petiole	
Length (mm)	244
Width (mm)	4
Petiole pubescence	medium
Petiole pose of hairs	outwards
Petiole color	145B
Attitude of hairs on petiole and pedicel	Outwards to horizontal
Petiolule	
Length (mm)	48
Width(mm)	3.2
Stolon	
Diameter (mm)	4
Stolon color	145A

-continued

Hybrid Patent Data Sheet (planted: October Year 1; measurement: November Year 2) Variety: PLAYA (A.K.A. ‘108926’)	
5	Widest diameter of stolon at point of attachment of leaf (mm) 4.78
	Stolon anthocyanin 187A
	Density of pubescence on the stolonMedium
	Stolon number 2 to 12
10	Stolon thickness Large
	Stolon attitude outwards
	Stolon size medium to large
Inflorescence	
	Petal/flower NA
15	Inflorescence even
	position relative
	Number of flowers per plant 30-40
	Fertility self-fertile
	Time of flowering March to April
	Corolla (mm) 13
	Calyx (mm) 5
20	Calyx color 137C
	Position of calyx attachment inserted
	Level of adherence of calyx High
	Petal length (mm) 17
	Petal width (mm) 7
	Petal per flower 5
25	Flower arrangement of petals free to touching
	Upper petal color 155C
	Lower petal color 155D
	Sepal length (mm) 19
	Sepal width (mm) 9
	Sepals per flower 10
30	Peduncle size (cm) 22.5
	Stipule height (mm) 27
	Stipule width (mm) 11
	Stipule attitude upwards
	Stipule coloration 145B
	Pedicel coloration 145A
35	Anther coloration 12A
	Stamen count 22
	Stamen shape dorsifixed
	Stamen length (mm) 4.03
Fruit	
	Fruit/truss 1-5
40	Length (mm) 37
	Width (mm) 29
	Fruit length/width ratio 1.27
	Core length (mm) 30
	Core width (mm) 9
	Glossiness medium
45	Fruiting truss attitude erect
	Fruit skin color 41A
	Evenness of fruit color medium
	Predominant fruit shape long-conical
	Difference in shape between primary & secondary fruits none to very slight
50	Width of the band without achenes medium
	Position of the achenes inserted
	Number of achenes per fruit 257
	Achene weight (g) 0.18
	Achene coloration 152D
	Flesh color 45A
55	excluding core 41A
	Color of fruit core 41A
	Firmness of flesh firm
	Texture when tasted medium
	Time of fruit ripening April
	Harvest maturity (50% of plants with ripe fruit) early
60	Grams of fruit/plant (g) 678
	(During peak season, June)
	Appearance Score 4
	(from 1-5, with 5 = best)
65	Storage longevity (e.g., 10 days to 29 days-13 days weeks)

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Hybrid Patent Data Sheet (planted: October Year 1; measurement: November Year 2) Variety: PLAYA (A.K.A. '108926')	
Cull rate: Non salable fruit production rate	<10%
Disease and pest resistance	Not tested
Acidity as measured by pH	3.26
Sweetness as measured by brix	9

When 'Playa' is compared to the proprietary female parent, 'Playa' has a lower height. The density of foliage of 'Playa' is heavy, while the density of foliage of the female parent is medium.

When 'Playa' is compared to the proprietary male parent, 'Playa' has stolons that are much thicker than the stolons of

the male parent. Additionally, 'Playa' presents smaller tri-foliate leaflets and much larger and fruit than the male parent.

When 'Playa' is compared to 'Seascape' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 07,614), 'Playa' has a density of foliage that is heavy, while the density of foliage of Seascape' is light. The plant vigor of 'Playa' is high, while the plant vigor of 'Seascape' is moderate. The leaf glossiness of 'Playa' ranges from medium to weak, while the leaf glossiness of 'Seascape' is medium. The number of leaflets of 'Playa' is 66, while the number of leaflets of 'Seascape' is 49. 'Playa' presents larger fruit than 'Seascape' as well. 'Playa' tri-foliate leaves have a more serrate shape relative to the crenate leaves of 'Seascape'.

The invention claimed is:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of strawberry plant named 'Playa' substantially as shown and described herein.

* * * * *

FIG. 1



FIG. 2



FIG. 3.



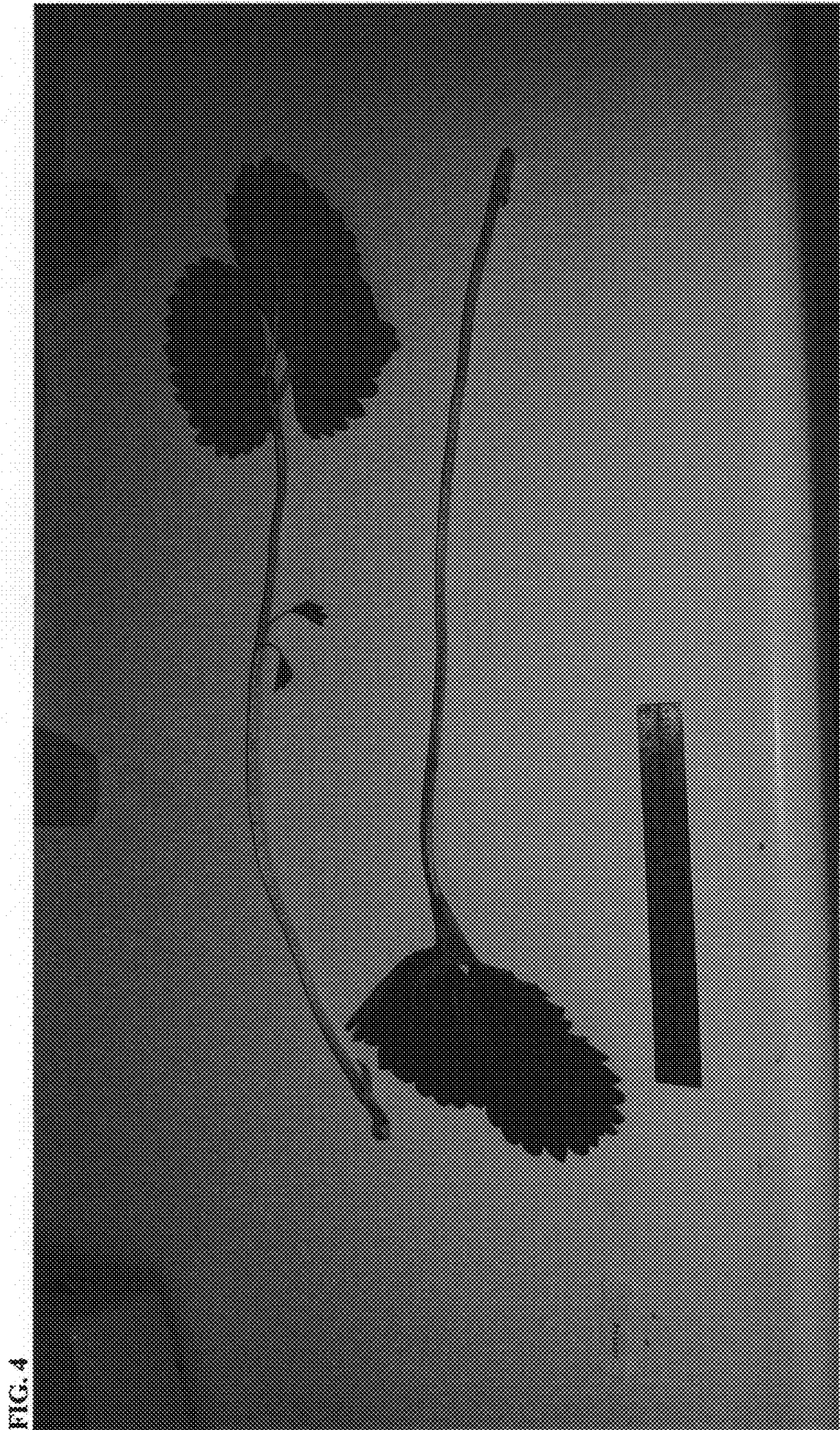


FIG. 4



FIG. 5